DESIGN DEPARTMENT (DD)

Faculty Members

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Vision

The Design Department at Rafik Hariri University strives to be the leader in high-standard, progressive education in Lebanon and the region. It aims to develop creative, well-informed, skilled professionals aware of their responsibility to solve visual problems in a dynamic global society. Our vision is a future in which RHU faculty, students, and alumni become trendsetters and innovators in the design world, both theoretically and practically.

Programs Offered

The Department of Design offers one program leading to a Bachelor of Science degree in Graphic Design. It also offers a minor in Graphic Design. Details of each program will follow.

GRAPHIC DESIGN PROGRAM

Mission

Our mission is to educate students to become successful thinkers and creative designers who can enhance human experience and improve communication. This is achieved through:

- Providing high-standard teaching methods and progressive curricula that deliver professional excellence.
- Educating designers to be socially and ethically responsible to serve a better community.
- Promote growth and innovation personally and academically to become successful leaders in the workplace.
- Mentoring students to tackle design challenges creatively and innovatively while adhering to design principles.
- Providing students coverage through diverse media forums, exhibitions, and events.
- Providing students with design perspectives from designers and thinkers outside RHU through juries, workshops, lectures, and seminars.
- Establishing and maintaining close relationships with the industry and other academic institutions to improve the curriculum, expand collaboration, and increase job opportunities for our students.

Objectives

- Provide students with both print and multimedia design courses.
- Provide students with the necessary thinking, planning, and execution skills to succeed in the workplace.
- Provide students with technologically advanced skills in new fields such as VR, AR, 3D Printing…
- Provide students with the key elements to develop a portfolio and CV that stand out in the market.
- Allow students to explore various platforms through personal creative skills.
- Emphasize theoretical and practical design aspects, completely understanding the design field.
- Explore the diverse roles of designers as effective visual creators, ethical and social beings, and problem solvers.

Program Outcomes

Upon successful completion of the BS program in Graphic Design, graduates will:

- Effectively communicate messages by juxtaposing images and type to a specific target audience.
- Acquire, articulate, and apply specialized terminology and knowledge relevant to graphic design, including relationships with other disciplines and contemporary global issues.
- Implement creative solutions from concept through completion using a formal process.
- Display competency in technical skills applicable to graphic design.
- Demonstrate the ability to use design-thinking strategies in an iterative design process.
- Apply design principles to develop strategic marketing and communication solutions for companies, products, and services.
- Be able to analyze, synthesize, and develop successful solutions.
- Become conceptual thinkers aware of social, cultural, and ethical issues…
- Access information through traditional and new technologies and synthesize this information for problem-solving activities.
- Understand the relationship of graphic design to other disciplines and society.
- Develop a professional resume, business card, and portfolio, and learn how to conduct a job search. They will also gain familiarity with the types of jobs available in the graphic design industry.

Career Opportunities

Graphic designers gain a broad range of knowledge and skills that equip them well to enter the professional field. Graphic Design offers vast opportunities in various fields, including TV stations, advertising agencies, design and packaging firms, editorial firms and magazines, branding agencies, interactive design firms (web and applications), 3D animation studios and gaming, photography studios, printing presses, illustration firms, and publishing houses. Furthermore, many NGOs, banks, and other business companies require in-house graphic designers. In addition to working full-time, local and international freelance projects are available for extra income and independent work, driven by high market demand.

Graphic Design is also an excellent foundation for careers in product management, marketing, and social media.

Program Overview

The RHU Graphic Design (GRDS) Program provides excellent teaching standards based on academic and creative research and professional practice. The graphic design department at RHU offers students a great opportunity to grow as individuals, nurture their unique style, and build self-confidence. Various design-related forums are explored, and students are taught skills for client communication and workplace success.

The graphic design program is based on a student-centered approach in which students gain extensive knowledge of design theory and a thinking approach essential to all

problem-solving. The program's curriculum, facilities, and committed faculty members ensure students' academic and personal growth in an environment that inspires learning and drives creativity.

BS in Graphic Design (111 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	12	-	9	9	30	27
College Requirement	-	-	-	-	-	0
Program Requirement	51	6	21	3	81	73
Credits	63	6	30	12	111	100

I. University Requirements (General Education)

The list of the University's required courses and their descriptions is presented on the introductory pages of the College of Arts and Sciences section of this catalog.

II. College Requirements

The diversity of the programs precludes the identification of college requirements common to all CAS programs.

III. Program Requirements

A. Fine Arts Requirements (18 credits)

As part of the Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design program, students must take 18 credit hours of Fine Arts requirement courses listed in the table below. These courses build a solid artistic and technical foundation that helps students excel in design.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
FADR 200	Drawing I	3	
FADR 202	Drawing II	3	FADR 200
FADR 210	Rendering and Perspective Techniques	3	
FADR 215	History of Art	3	
FADR 220	Fundamentals of 2D	3	
FADR 222	Fundamentals of 3D	3	FADR 220

B. Business Requirement

The business requirement is a three-credit course listed in the table below.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BMKA 200	Introduction to Marketing	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210

C. Mandatory Requirements

The set of mandatory graphic design courses encompasses the 51 credits listed in the table below.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
GRDS 203	Introduction to Graphic Design	3	GRDS 205
GRDS 205	Type I	3	GRDS 220
GRDS 222	Advanced Digital Media	3	GRDS 220
GRDS 230	Photography I	3	
GRDS 300	Illustration	3	GRDS 220, FADR 202
GRDS 305	Type II	3	GRDS 205
GRDS 306	Type III	3	GRDS 222, GRDS 305
GRDS 310	Design I	3	GRDS 203, GRDS 220
GRDS 311	Design II	3	GRDS 310
GRDS 345	History of Graphic Design	3	FADR 215
GRDS 399	Co-op Training Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing.
GRDS 409	Design Writing Research	3	GRDS 310
GRDS 411	Design III	3	GRDS 311, GRDS 306
GRDS 412	Design IV	3	GRDS 411, GRDS 409
GRDS 423	Motion Graphics	3	GRDS 220
GRDS 424	Web and Interactive Design	3	GRDS 423
GRDS 450	Branding and Advertising	3	GRDS 411
GRDS 452	Digital Illustration	2	GRDS 222, GRDS 300

D. Major Elective Requirements

Students must take 6 credit hours of major elective courses to deepen their knowledge of innovative disciplines and current issues in the design field.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
GRDS 320	UI/UX Design	3	GRDS 220
GRDS 330	Photography II	3	GRDS 230
GRDS 331	Digital Processing	3	GRDS 222
GRDS 350	3D Printing & Prototyping	3	GRDS 222
GRDS 355	Calligraphy	3	GRDS 305
GRDS 375	3D Animation	3	GRDS 423
GRDS 385	VR Illustration and Sculpting	3	GRDS 300
GRDS 381	Book Binding	3	Junior Standing
GRDS 402	Silkscreen	3	GRDS 300
GRDS 403	Painting	3	FADR 202
GRDS 436	Game Design	3	GRDS 220
GRDS 498	Special Topics in Graphic Design	3	

E. Social Science/Culture Requirement

Students must take three extra-credit hours in social science/culture to fulfill the five

humanities and social sciences courses required for accreditation.

F. Co-op Training Experience

Each student must complete 8 weeks of practical training in a field related to their interests. The Co-op experience is usually fulfilled during the summer semester of the third year in the program. The Co-op office matches the Co-op assignment with the student's field of study and the employer's interest. A faculty member follows up on a student's progress throughout the Co-op period by conducting field visits to ensure that the student's performance is aligned with their aspirations and the employer's needs. Students must submit a formal report, a poster, and a presentation on their Co-op experience. While ENGL 217 and Senior Standing are the prerequisites for pursuing co-op training, the program is mandated to stipulate additional conditions.

Study Plan

The Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design encompasses 111 credit hours spread over six semesters and three summer sessions, with the last dedicated to the CO-OP experience. The following study plan is a roadmap for the student's smooth progression toward graduation.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
Year 1, Semester 1 (15 Credits)			
ENGL 210	English Composition & Rhetoric	3	Placement
GRDS 220	Introduction to Digital Media	3	
FADR 200	Drawing I	3	
FADR 215	History of Art	3	
FADR 220	Fundamentals of 2D	3	
Year 1, Semester 2 (15 Credits)			
GRDS 205	Type I	3	Co-req.: GRDS 220
GRDS 222	Advanced Digital Media	3	GRDS 220
FADR 202	Drawing II	3	FADR 200
FADR 210	Rendering and Perspective Techniques	3	
FADR 222	Fundamentals of 3D	3	FADR 220
Summer Session (9 credits)			
ARAB 212	Arabic Language and Communication	2	
GRDS 203	Introduction to Graphic Design	3	GRDS 205
GRDS 230	Photography I	3	
	Community & Sustainability	1	Co-req.: ENGL 210
Year 2, Semester 1 (18 Credits)			
BMKA 200	Introduction to Marketing	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210
ENGL 217	Professional Communication Skills	3	ENGL 210
GRDS 300	Illustration	3	GRDS 220, FADR 202
GRDS 305	Type II	3	GRDS 205

GRDS 310	Design I	3	GRDS 203, GRDS 220
	Social Sciences/Culture Elective I	3	
Year 2, Semester 2 (15 Credits)			
GRDS 306	Type III	3	GRDS 222, GRDS 305
GRDS 311	Design II	3	GRDS 310
GRDS 423	Motion Graphics	3	GRDS 220
GRDS 335	Production	3	GRDS 222
GRDS 345	History of Graphic Design	3	FADR 215
Summer Session (9 Credits)			
GRDS 360	Visual Perception & Infographics	3	GRDS 311
	Social Sciences / Culture Elective II	3	
	Humanities/Fine Arts Elective	3	
Year 3, Semester 1 (15 Credits)			
GRDS 409	Design Writing Research	3	GRDS 310
GRDS 411	Design III	3	GRDS 311, GRDS 306
GRDS 424	Web and Interactive Design	3	GRDS 423
GRDS 440	Design & Social Impact	3	Junior standing
	Major Elective I	3	
Year 3, Semester 2 (14 Credits)			
GRDS 412	Design IV	3	GRDS 411, GRDS 409
GRDS 452	Digital Illustration	2	GRDS 222, GRDS 300
GRDS 450	Branding & Advertising	3	GRDS 411
	Social Sciences/Culture Elective III	3	
	Major Elective II	3	
Summer Session (1 Credit)			
GRDS 399	Co-op Training Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing

Courses Description

I. Mandatory Requirements

Fine Arts Courses

Descriptions of the Fine Arts Requirement courses are given below.

FADR 200	Drawing I	3(2,2)
This course is a comprehensive introduction to the art of drawing. Students learn how to represent objects, planes, and volumes accurately and proportionally by developing hand-to-eye coordination with lines, shades, tones, and wet and dry media. The course introduces drawing techniques, composition principles, perspective basics, and various media to prepare students with the essential ingredients needed to grow in the design field.		

FADR 202	Drawing II	3(2,2)
This drawing course teaches students the basics of drawing the human figure through an understanding of its anatomy and proportions. It emphasizes the use of the human figure in space as a compositional element. Students will explore the potential and limits of media and materials. Students will begin to form a personal approach to drawing and even develop a personal drawing/illustrating style. **Prerequisite**: FADR 200.		

FADR 210	Rendering and Perspective Techniques	3(2,2)
This course introduces students to perspective techniques in rendering three-dimensional objects and scenes on two-dimensional surfaces. Students learn to apply perspective drawing, composition, and conceptualization to develop visual communication skills. Design, composition, light rendering, and perspective are explored to enhance the students' drawing and rendering techniques.		

FADR 215	History of Art	3(3,0)
This course explores the major forms of artistic expression from the ancient world to the present, from various cultural perspectives. Students learn to examine and analyze works of art in their historical context and to articulate what they see or experience in a meaningful way. This course covers the pre-Renaissance, Renaissance, and post-Renaissance periods, as well as the rich layers of 19th- and 20th-century modern art up to the manifestations of our present day.		

FADR 220	Fundamentals of 2D	3(2,2)
This course focuses on the student's visual awareness by introducing the fundamentals of 2-D design elements, including line, texture, pattern, tone, form, color, light, partial illusion, balance, and proportion. Students also explore and experiment with design principles such as repetition, variety, emphasis, and movement. This course broadens the understanding of compositional devices, dynamics, and methods. It also aims to		

develop a clear understanding of visual organization, shape interaction, and color theory.		
FADR 222	**Fundamentals of 3D**	**3(2,2)**
This course extends two-dimensional design concepts into volumetric relationships, emphasizing design concepts through structural and sculptural forms. Students will work in various media, including paper, cardboard, wood, wire, metal, and plaster, to explore concepts of modularity, sequence and series, relief, contour, structure, symmetry, and asymmetry as they relate to the study of forms in nature. Students will also examine the function of space, volume, mass, plane, and line. The main emphasis of this course is the development of critical thinking, technical, and visual aesthetic skills. **Prerequisite**: FADR 220.		

Business Course Requirement

The Graphic Design program requires one business course, BMKA 200, as described below.

BMKA 200	**Introduction to Marketing**	**3(3,0)**
This course introduces the basic principles, theories, and marketing practices in our modern, ever-changing business environment. The course covers the marketing process activities of creating value for customers and capturing value from customers in return. It also discusses the marketing mix and how to build long-term customer relationships. Students will analyze case studies about a “real-life” product or service. Videos and in-class discussions on current marketing topics will assist in the learning experience. **Co-requisite**: ENGL 210		

Major Graphic Design Courses

A description of the Graphic Design courses follows.

GRDS 203	**Introduction to Graphic Design**	**3(3,0)**
Graphic design is a creative process that combines art and technology to communicate ideas visually. This course introduces students to graphic design by exploring the elements, principles, and design process. It focuses on the design process, from the initial stage of choosing a topic through the intermediate working stages to the final presentation. It is a theoretical course that includes practical exercises in visual communication, organization, and perception. Projects explore the various design dimensions to fully comprehend their expressive power as a visually communicative tool and a problem-solving method. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 205.		

GRDS 205	**Type I**	**3(3,0)**
Type, characters, and letterforms are the essential building blocks of visual communication. In this course, students learn to express ideas not only through word meaning but also by manipulating the shape of a typographic character, thereby improving the quality of information and communication. This introductory course teaches students the anatomy of type, essential type terminology, the history of type categorization and standardization, and the difference between calligraphy and typography. **Prerequisite**: GRDS 220.		